

piece of it. We were majorly relying on our neighbours for that and once the supply chain disruption hit, the entire ecosystem came to a standstill,” informs Shivam Dikshit, vice president, IoTfy.

Another report by Mckinsey, accepting the supply-chain challenges, sheds light on six things that can help in bettering operations in the supply chains. These include:

1. Create transparency on multi-tier supply chains by establishing a list of critical components, determining their origin of supply, and identifying alternative sources.

2. Estimate available inventory along the value chain—including spare parts and after-sales stock—for use as a bridge to keep production running and enable delivery to customers.

3. Assess realistic final-customer demand and respond to (or, where possible, contain) shortage-buying behaviour of customers.

4. Optimise production and distribution capacity to ensure employee safety, such as by supplying personal protective equipment (PPE) and engaging with communication teams to share infection-risk levels and work-from-home options. These steps will enable leaders to understand current and projected capacity levels in both workforce and materials.



5. Identify and secure logistics capacity, estimating capacity and accelerating, where possible, and being flexible on transportation mode, when required.

6. Manage cash and net working capital by running stress tests to understand where supply-chain issues will start to cause a financial impact.

Dikshit further explains that the pandemic gave birth to a new market, which demanded products that do not require physical touch to be operated. These products, as per him, became

possible only because of the digital technologies available in the market.

“We continue to get inquiries from Marquee brands about the availability of touchless switches that can be deployed in consumer electronics like air-conditioners. Providing hands-free experience to end users continues to remain a part of strategies that were born out of the pandemic,” Dikshit says.

There are two kinds of companies in the world when it comes to deploying IoT—those that are proactive, and others that are reactive. **Proactive companies were able to deal much better with the pandemic than the reactive ones. Dikshit explains that the percentage of proactive ones in India is less than one.**

Tamboli adds that when working on a digital strategy, one should not approach the same with words like IoT, but with a problem solving approach. He says, “Don’t lead with words like IoT, but lead with the problem that you want to solve, and the things will fall in place.”

Mckinsey, in a report, states that manufacturers who are using digital transformation to develop new or enhanced ways of operating their businesses have recorded 30 to 50 percent reduction in machine downtime, 15 to 30 percent improvement in labour productivity, 10 to 30 percent increases in throughput, and 10 to 20 percent decreases in the cost of quality. Most of these have included data, computa-

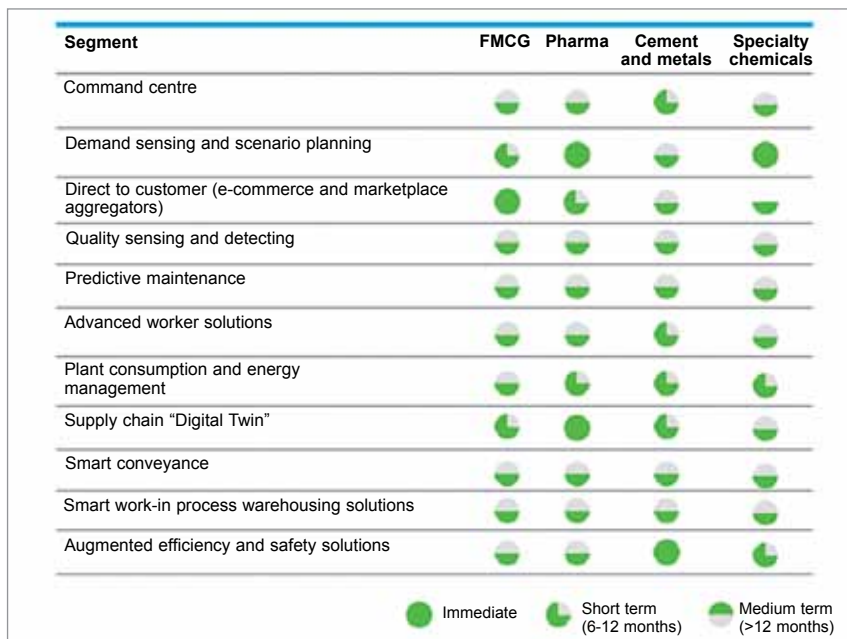


Fig. 3: Relative relevance of advanced technology use cases across industries in a post-Covid-19 scenario (Source: Deloitte)